

Analysis Notes

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June 6, 2026

Theorem 0.1 (Hölder's inequality). *Let $p, q \in [1, \infty]$ satisfy $\frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q} = 1$ and let f and g be measurable functions. Then*

$$\|fg\|_1 \leq \|f\|_p \|g\|_q$$

Proof. The case $p = \infty$ is trivial. Assume $p, q < \infty$. We first prove the following auxiliary inequality: If $s, t > 0$, then

$$st \leq \frac{s^p}{p} + \frac{t^q}{q}.$$

Let $\sigma, \tau \in \mathbb{R}$, and set $s = e^\sigma, t = e^\tau$. Since e^x is convex and

$$\frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q} = 1$$

we obtain

$$e^{\sigma+\tau} \leq \frac{e^{p\sigma}}{p} + \frac{e^{q\tau}}{q}.$$

Hence

$$st \leq \frac{s^p}{p} + \frac{t^q}{q}.$$

Using this inequality for $(s, t) = (|f|, |g|)$, we obtain

$$|fg| \leq \frac{|f|^p}{p} + \frac{|g|^q}{q}.$$

Integrating both sides, we obtain

$$\|fg\|_1 \leq \frac{\|f\|_p^p}{p} + \frac{\|g\|_q^q}{q}. \tag{1}$$

Setting $C = \|f\|_p \|g\|_q$, $\tilde{f} = \frac{f}{\|f\|_p}$, $\tilde{g} = \frac{g}{\|g\|_q}$, we obtain

$$\|\tilde{f}\|_p^p = \|\tilde{g}\|_q^q = 1$$

The case $C = \infty$ is trivial. So, let $C < \infty$. Then,

$$C^{-1}\|fg\|_1 = \|\tilde{f}\tilde{g}\|_1 \stackrel{(1)}{\leq} \frac{\|\tilde{f}\|_p^p}{p} + \frac{\|\tilde{g}\|_q^q}{q} = \frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q} = 1.$$

Multiplying both sides by C , we obtain

$$\|fg\|_1 \leq \|f\|_p \|g\|_q.$$

□